

Daily Bible Note

Date: June 1, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Corinthians 11:1-16

1 "Imitate me, just as I also imitate Christ."

2 "Now I praise you, brethren, that you remember me in all things and keep the traditions just as I delivered them to you."

3 "But I want you to know that the head of every man is Christ, the head of woman is man, and the head of Christ is God."

4 "Every man praying or prophesying, having his head covered, dishonors his head."

5 "But every woman who prays or prophesies with her head uncovered dishonors her head, for that is one and the same as if her head were shaved."

6 "For if a woman is not covered, let her also be shorn. But if it is shameful for a woman to be shorn or shaved, let her be covered."

7 "For a man indeed ought not to cover his head, since he is the image and glory of God; but woman is the glory of man."

8 "For man is not from woman, but woman from man."

9 "Nor was man created for the woman, but woman for the man."

10 "For this reason the woman ought to have a symbol of authority on her head, because of the angels."

11 "Nevertheless, neither is man independent of woman, nor woman independent of man, in the Lord."

12 "For as woman came from man, even so man also comes through woman; but all things are from God."

13 "Judge among yourselves. Is it proper for a woman to pray to God with her head uncovered?"

14 "Does not even nature itself teach you that if a man has long hair, it is a dishonor to

him?"

15 "But if a woman has long hair, it is a glory to her; for her hair is given to her for a covering."

16 "But if anyone seems to be contentious, we have no such custom, nor do the churches of God."

II. Key Summary

- Head coverings carried a specific social meaning in Paul's world — across Greek, Roman, and Jewish cultures, a woman appearing in public without a veil signaled she was under no one's authority or protection, and in some contexts carried a moral stigma. Paul's instructions were a direct response to this context, not arbitrary rule-making.

- "Head" means role and responsibility, not ranking by value (v.3): The chain God → Christ → man → woman describes structure, not worth — just as Jesus fully submitted to the Father yet is equally God.

- Structure and interdependence belong together (v.11-12): Right after the headship teaching, Paul pivots to say neither men nor women are independent of each other — the structure is meant to help both flourish, not for one to overpower the other.

III. Passage Analysis

Being Under Authority Doesn't Diminish Who You Are

"Jesus was totally under the authority of God the Father, yet He is equally God. When God calls women in the church to recognize the headship of men, it is not because women are unequal or inferior, but because there is a God-ordained order of authority to be respected." [1]

Paul places Jesus inside this structure deliberately — to separate rank from identity. Who leads and who follows says nothing about whose identity is more complete. Choosing to submit and being forced to comply feel completely different.

The "Nevertheless" Is Paul's Intentional Turn

"Men and women were made for one another — mutual comforts and blessings, not one a slave, and the other a tyrant." [2]

The "nevertheless" in v.11 is not casual. After laying out the authority structure, Paul immediately adds this correction: the goal is not hierarchy for its own sake, but partnership. Men and women both come from God — and both need each other.

IV. Reflection Question

Has there been a time when you were put in a "listening" role — the newest person in a group, the youngest in the family, just a regular team member — and you caught yourself thinking, "Does this mean I matter less?" If even Jesus submitted to the Father's authority, and that never diminished who He was, does that change how you see your own place in that situation?

References

- [1] Enduring Word, David Guzik,
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-corinthians-11/>
- [2] BibleHub.com, Matthew Henry,
https://biblehub.com/commentaries/1_corinthians/11-2.htm